

# Open Visual Gutenberg Builder (Working Title)

## Vision

Create an open-source visual WordPress page builder that delivers the ease of Elementor and Divi while storing everything as native Gutenberg blocks.

## Core Principles

- Open Source
  - Native Gutenberg Output
  - No Shortcode Lock-In
  - Lightweight Frontend
  - Modern Visual Editing
  - Fast Loading Pages
  - Responsive by Default
  - Developer Friendly
  - Extensible Architecture
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## Problem Statement

Current options force users to choose between:

### Gutenberg

Pros:

- Native WordPress
- Fast
- Clean Output

Cons:

- Less Visual
- Design Workflow Feels Technical

### Elementor / Divi

Pros:

- Excellent Visual Experience
- Easy Drag-and-Drop

Cons:

- Heavy
- Vendor Lock-In

- Large CSS Output
  - Proprietary Storage
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## Product Goal

Provide:

Elementor-style visual editing with Gutenberg-native storage.

Users should be able to build modern websites visually while maintaining complete ownership of their content.

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## Unique Selling Points

- Visual Editing
  - Native Gutenberg Blocks
  - No Vendor Lock-In
  - Lightweight CSS
  - Responsive Controls
  - Built-In Animations
  - Built-In Forms
  - Open Source
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## Technology Stack

### Frontend

- React
- TypeScript
- dnd-kit
- Zustand

### WordPress

- Gutenberg APIs
- WordPress Block Editor APIs
- WordPress Data APIs

### Build Tools

- Vite
- TypeScript
- ESLint
- Prettier

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# Repository Structure

```
builder/  
├── packages/  
│   ├── editor/  
│   ├── serializer/  
│   ├── blocks/  
│   ├── animations/  
│   ├── forms/  
│   ├── history/  
│   └── core/  
├── plugin/  
│   ├── php/  
│   ├── assets/  
│   └── build/  
├── docs/  
├── examples/  
└── website/
```

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## MVP Scope (Version 1.0)

### Layout Blocks

#### Container

- Width
- Max Width
- Padding
- Margin
- Background
- Border Radius

#### Grid

- Columns
- Rows
- Gap
- Responsive Layout

## Spacer

- Adjustable Height
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## Content Blocks

### Heading

- H1-H6
- Typography Controls

### Text

- Rich Text Editing

### Button

- Text
- Link
- Style Controls

### Image

- Media Library Integration

### Icon

- SVG Support

### Video

- YouTube
  - Vimeo
  - Self Hosted
- 

## Form Builder

### Form Block

Supported Fields:

- Name
- Text
- Email
- Phone
- Number
- Textarea
- Select
- Checkbox

- Radio
- Submit Button

Actions:

- Email Notification
- Database Storage

Future Integrations:

- Mailchimp
  - Brevo
  - HubSpot
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## Responsive Controls

**Desktop**

**Tablet**

**Mobile**

Properties:

- Width
  - Margin
  - Padding
  - Typography
  - Visibility
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## Animation Engine

**Entrance Animations**

- Fade In
- Fade Up
- Fade Down
- Fade Left
- Fade Right
- Zoom In
- Zoom Out

Controls:

- Duration
- Delay
- Offset

Architecture:

```
data-animation="fade-up"
data-duration="600"
```

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## Template Library

### Landing Pages

- SaaS
- Agency
- Portfolio

### Sections

- Hero
  - Features
  - Testimonials
  - Pricing
  - CTA
  - Contact
- 

## Phase 1 - Architecture Validation

Duration: 2 Weeks

### Sprint 0

#### Goal

Validate Gutenberg serialization.

#### Tasks

##### Project Setup

- Create WordPress plugin scaffold
- Configure React
- Configure TypeScript
- Configure Vite

##### Serializer

- Layout JSON Schema
- JSON → Gutenberg Conversion
- Gutenberg → JSON Conversion

## Validation

- Round Trip Testing
- Nested Containers
- Nested Blocks

## Success Criteria

JSON  
↓  
Gutenberg  
↓  
JSON

No data loss.

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# Phase 2 - Core Editor

Duration: 4 Weeks

## Sprint 1

### Canvas Foundation

Tasks:

- Editor Canvas
- Selection System
- Component Registry
- Rendering Engine

Deliverable:

User can add and select elements.

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## Sprint 2

### Drag and Drop

Tasks:

- dnd-kit Integration
- Reordering
- Nesting
- Drop Indicators

Deliverable:

Elementor-style drag-and-drop.

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## Phase 3 - Core Blocks

Duration: 4 Weeks

### Sprint 3

#### Layout Blocks

Tasks:

- Container
  - Grid
  - Spacer
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### Sprint 4

#### Content Blocks

Tasks:

- Heading
- Text
- Button
- Image
- Icon
- Video

Deliverable:

Build complete landing pages.

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## Phase 4 - Responsive Design

Duration: 2 Weeks

### Sprint 5

Tasks:

- Breakpoint System
- Device Switcher
- Responsive Controls



- Preview Mode

Deliverable:

Desktop, Tablet, Mobile editing.

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## Phase 5 - Animations

Duration: 2 Weeks

### Sprint 6

Tasks:

- Animation Engine
- Fade Effects
- Slide Effects
- Zoom Effects
- Delay Controls
- Duration Controls

Deliverable:

Modern interactive websites.

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## Phase 6 - Forms

Duration: 3 Weeks

### Sprint 7

Tasks:

- Form Block
- Field Blocks
- Submission Handler
- Database Storage
- Email Notifications

Deliverable:

Working contact forms.

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## Phase 7 - Productivity Features

Duration: 3 Weeks

### Sprint 8

Tasks:

- Undo
- Redo
- Duplicate
- Copy
- Paste
- Delete

Deliverable:

Production-ready editing workflow.

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## Phase 8 - Templates

Duration: 2 Weeks

### Sprint 9

Tasks:

- Template Export
- Template Import
- Template Library
- Starter Pages

Deliverable:

Fast page creation.

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## Phase 9 - Gutenberg Integration

Duration: 3 Weeks

### Sprint 10

Tasks:

- Import Existing Gutenberg Pages

- Edit Existing Pages
- Export Native Gutenberg Blocks
- Validation Testing

Deliverable:

Complete Gutenberg compatibility.

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## Phase 10 - Public Beta

Duration: 2 Weeks

### Sprint 11

Tasks:

- Documentation
- Website
- Demo Site
- GitHub Actions
- Plugin Packaging
- WordPress.org Submission

Deliverable:

Public Beta Release

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## Version 1.0 Success Metrics

### Technical

- Lighthouse Performance > 90
- Page Size < Elementor Equivalent
- Native Gutenberg Compatibility

### Product

- 500 GitHub Stars
  - 1,000 Plugin Installs
  - First Community Contributors
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# Future Roadmap

## Version 1.1

- Global Styles
- Design Tokens
- Theme Presets

## Version 1.2

- Dynamic Content
- Query Loops
- ACF Integration

## Version 1.3

- Theme Builder
- Header Builder
- Footer Builder

## Version 1.4

- WooCommerce Builder

## Version 2.0

- Advanced Animations
- Popup Builder
- Marketing Integrations
- AI Layout Generation
- Figma Import
- Collaboration Features

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## Project Mission

Build the fastest, most developer-friendly visual page builder for WordPress while remaining fully compatible with Gutenberg and preserving user ownership of content.